

The transition from analogue to digital video cameras has opened up a wealth of possibilities. In analogue, the video was transmitted as complete frames (along with the accompanying audio) and then interpreted by the device into audio and video. This interpretation resulted in a small loss of quality. Digital video does not suffer this quality loss, as all the data is received exactly as transmitted. From its early days of being a heavy piece of iron only seen at weddings and other important functions, the video camera or camcorder has evolved such that you now have a plethora of choices that can appeal to every type of user.

1.1 Identify your needs

Before even stepping into a store to look at the choices available, there are two questions you need to ask yourself: What is your budget? And, What are you going to use it for?

When considering the budget, be realistic. Entry-level models start from around Rs 30,000 or less. Advanced and professional models cost much more, climbing into the Rs 1 lakh range and beyond. As with any consumer electronics product, you pay more for features and functionalities, compactness and compatibility.

Assuming the budget isn't a constraint, you should first get a fix on your needs.

If your shooting is primarily indoors or at family events, the camcorder should have good low-light performance and should be able to take good still pictures. An inbuilt "auto" light that recognises the light conditions

